The ELIXIR Research Data Management (RDM) Community

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The RDM Community is an inclusive network for professionals in Research Data Management (RDM) within the Life Sciences, open to members of ELIXIR Nodes and beyond. It promotes cross-organization and cross-country collaboration, focusing on those actively engaged in implementing and supporting RDM practices aligned with Open Science and the FAIR principles.

Our purpose is to connect RDM experts to share knowledge, experiences, and best practices, enhancing efficiency and confidence in delivering harmonized RDM services and training for researchers. We uphold Open Science and FAIR principles as guiding values, fostering a strong knowledge-sharing network.

Roles

Community members: >250 registered

- Propose or vote on topics for further exploration
- Actively participate to knowledge exchange
- Share and implement community outcomes within local network

Liaisons

Liaisons with other initiatives

- Identification of synergies
- Exchange of ideas
- Harmonisation and alignment of approaches
- Minimisation of redundancy
- First point of contact and communication channel

Task leads

Leads of spontaneous initiatives suggested by the Community or for project tasks

- Plan and execute specific activities
- Ensure the inclusion of all (volunteer) members in the activities

How we work

Suggest a topic

Vote your favourite

Share & discuss

Contribute to RDM Resources

Outputs

RDM Community White Paper:

Foundations and Vision

D'Anna F, Jareborg N, Jetten M *et al.* A research data management (RDM) community for ELIXIR [version 2; peer review: 2 approved]. *F1000Research* 2024, **13**(ELIXIR):230
https://doi.org/10.12688/f1000research.146301.2

RDM Community Framework

Identity: Who is this Community for?
Purpose: Why does the Community exist?
Values: Which principles are important to us?
Experiences we share
Why you should join and How
Roles, Rules, Governance
Communication

Andrabi, M., D'Anna, F., Jareborg, N., & Jetten, M. (2025, April 17). ELIXIR RDM Community framework. ELIXIR. **https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.15235047**

Onboarding Manual

Getting started in the Community
How to participate and engage
How to contribute

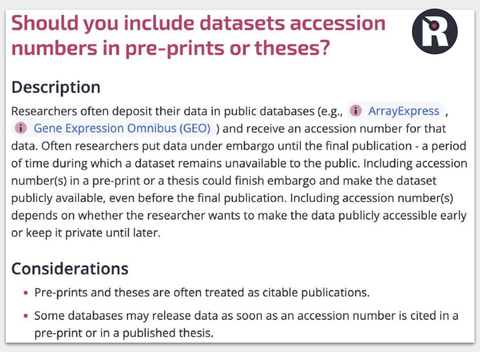
Available via the intranet!

https://elixir-europe.org/documents/elixir-rdm-community-onboarding

User Journeys

How you can use our resources to address common tasks in research data management.

Welter, D., Pérez Sitjà, X., & Bösl, K. (2025). Research Data Management User Journeys. Zenodo.
https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.14710086



Should you include datasets accession numbers in pre-prints or theses?

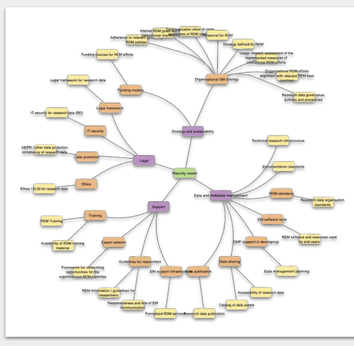
Description

Researchers often deposit their data in public databases (e.g., ArrayExpress, Gene Expression Omnibus (GEO)) and receive an accession number for that data. Often researchers put data under embargo until the final publication - a period of time during which a dataset remains unavailable to the public. Including accession number(s) in a pre-print or a thesis could finish embargo and make the dataset publicly available, even before the final publication. Including accession number(s) depends on whether the researcher wants to make the data publicly accessible early or keep it private until later.

Considerations

- Pre-prints and theses are often treated as citable publications.
- Some databases may release data as soon as an accession number is cited in a pre-print or in a published thesis.

Ongoing



Maturity Model for RDM service providers

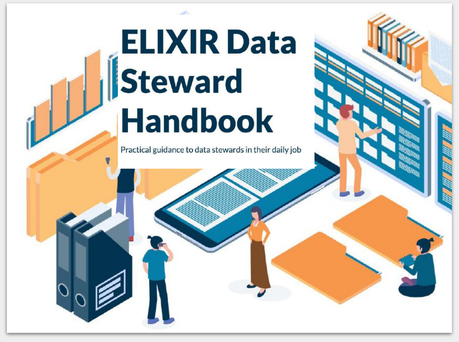
Assessing organisational RDM activities

RDM Trainer Network

The ELIXIR RDM Trainer Network brings together life sciences professionals working in upskilling, training or educational activities around RDM and Data Stewardship.

We aim to be the enablers of knowledge exchange, a hub for sharing relevant training materials and discussing common challenges across the life sciences in RDM training.

Join the RDM Trainer Network



Implementation Study

Learning paths

For data stewards and researchers

Contact

Research Data Management Community co-leads
rdm-coleads@elixir-europe.org
https://elixir-europe.org/communities/research-data-management

DATAREX - Data Management for Research in ELIXIR

ELIXIR ALL HANDS 2025